Yusuke Shono

Editor & Curator · Tokyo

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Profile

Yusuke Shono is an editor and curator working across two practices — publishing and exhibitions. With MASSAGE MAGAZINE as his base, he has built a space of discourse and display centered on digital, generative, and computer art. His recent curatorial projects investigate contemporary technologies such as blockchain and AI, and through major exhibitions at NEORT++ (Bakurochō, Tokyo) he is building networks across digital art communities at home and abroad.

Current Roles

2026–	*Main Curator*, NEORT++, Tokyo
2022–	*Committee Member / Curator*, Proof of X
2022–	*Contributor*, Right Click Save
2005–	*Editor-in-Chief*, 100 Japanese Motion Graphic Creators (BNN)
2004–	*Publisher / Editor-in-Chief*, MASSAGE MAGAZINE

Juries & Advisory

2024–26 — The Lumen Prize
International Selectors Committee · The Lumen Prize (London)

2026 — Domestic Creator Creation Support Program (FY2026)
Advisor · Agency for Cultural Affairs — Media Arts Creator Development Support Project

2025 — Domestic Creator Creation Support Program (FY2025)
Advisor · Agency for Cultural Affairs — Media Arts Creator Development Support Project

Teaching

2015 — Ochanomizu Art School
Part-time Lecturer (Apr–Jul 2015)

2011–17 — Tama Art University
Part-time Lecturer (Apr 2011 – Apr 2017)

Selected Record

2025

Dec 2025 · EDITORIAL
CCBT Annual 2024
Editor (with Ayumi Yagi) · CCBT, Tokyo Metropolitan Foundation for History and Culture
Annual report on CCBT's FY2024 programs.

Dec 2025
CURATORIAL

Patterns of Entanglement

Co-curation · NEORT++, Tokyo · with Alex Estorick (Right Click Save)

An international exhibition on media ecologies and AI, presented alongside five digital studies released in collaboration with Verse.

Sep–Oct 2025
CURATORIAL

Computational Poetry

Co-curation · NEORT++, Tokyo · with Zeroichi Arakawa (IAMAS)

Re-reading the 1950s concrete poetry concept of "verbivocovisual" as a poetics of code. Presented in conjunction with Verse Works.

Apr 2025
CRITICAL

MOMENT 2025: Talk with hasaqui

Speaker · NEORT++, Tokyo · with hasaqui

Mar 2025
EDITORIAL

CCBT Annual 2022–2023

Editor (with Ayumi Yagi) · CCBT, Tokyo Metropolitan Foundation for History and Culture

Covers the 18 months from CCBT's opening in October 2022 to March 2024, with 32 projects and events and interviews with artists and participants.

Ongoing
EDITORIAL

MASSAGE MAGAZINE

Publisher / Editor-in-Chief

Founded in 2004; continuing operation.

2024

Sep–Oct 2024
CURATORIAL

Patterns of Flow

Co-curation · NEORT++, Tokyo · with Alex Estorick (Right Click Save)

Revisiting early Japanese computer art through the work of Hiroshi Kawano. Related DOMMUNE talk in October 2024.

2024
CRITICAL

Questions for Art & Technology #1: Living as Human

Author · CCBT, Tokyo Metropolitan Foundation for History and Culture

Notes on a lecture series with media art pioneer Masaki Fujihata.

2024
CURATORIAL

Machine-Made Aura

Curation · K Art Gallery

May 2024
CURATORIAL

Web as a Medium

Co-curation (MASSAGE MAGAZINE × NEORT++) · NEORT++, Tokyo

Presented with the Tezos NFT platform objkt.one, including an NFT drop on May 16. Artists: 0xhaiku, exonemo, Canek Zapata, Damjanski, Jan Robert Leegte, Joan Heemskerk, Kitasenju Design, Leander Herzog, Violet Forest, Yehwan Song.

Jan 2024
CURATORIAL

Proof of X — Decoding PFP Culture

Committee / Curation · Shibuya PARCO Gallery X, Tokyo

Featuring Akihiro Kato, CryptoCitizens (Bright Moments), CryptoPunks, int art, Kai Yoshizawa + Baku Hashimoto + MASSAGE MAGAZINE, KUMALEON, Milady Maker, Mitchell F. Chan, Nahiko, NIINOMI, PIV, Toshi (A to Z).

2023

2023
CRITICAL

On Curation — Blockchain as a New Medium

Author · Right Click Save (curatorial essay series, vol. 1)

Right Click Save described Shono as "the architect of Proof of X" sharing his vision for blockchain as a medium.

2023
CRITICAL

The Democratization and Fluidity of Expression

Author · JAGDA — The Graphic Design Review

From Beeple's Christie's sale ($69,346,250), the essay traces how digital tools, social media, and blockchain chain together to mark the endpoint of the "democratization of expression."

Jun 2023
CURATORIAL

Proof of X — Blockchain As A New Medium For Art

Curator commentary / Committee · THE FACE DAIKANYAMA, Tokyo

Featuring exonemo (Proof of Non-Existence, 2023), 0xDEAFBEEF (Caves, 2022), 0xhaiku, PIV (Default Punks, 2022), and others.

Jun 2023
CRITICAL

Proof of X @ DOMMUNE

Speaker · SUPER DOMMUNE

Lineup: Akihiro Kato, ALTERNATIVE MACHINE, Ara, EXCALIBUR, Gin, hasaqui, NIINOMI, Toshi, Yusuke Shono, and others.

Apr 2023
EDITORIAL

100 Japanese Motion Graphic Creators + NEWCOMER

Editor-in-Chief / Designer · BNN

The first print edition in six years. 100 main creators plus 100 NEWCOMERs. ISBN 978-4-8025-1269-5.

2022

Dec 2022
CRITICAL

Right Click Live × KUMALEON

Panelist + Reporter · Tokyo

Panel "NFTs and the New Creator Economy" with Yukiko Shikata, Keitaro Shii, hasaqui, and Yusuke Shono. Resulting Right Click Save report: "Right Click Live and Japan's New NFT Scene."

2022
EDITORIAL

THE NEW CREATOR ECONOMY

Lead Editor + Contributor ("CryptoArt Pre-History") · BNN

Co-editors: hasaqui, Tsuyoshi Hirose, Noriko Taguchi, Natsumi Fujita. Contributors: Yukiko Shikata, Shunsuke Takao, Ayumu Nagamatsu, Kosuke Nagai, consome, MaskJiro, nobumei, and others.

Apr 2022
CURATORIAL

Proof of X — NFT as New Media Art

Committee / Curation · NEORT++, Tokyo

First edition of the Proof of X series.

2019

2019
CURATORIAL

PHENOMENON: RGB

Curation · Laforet Museum Harajuku, Tokyo

Treating the RGB display environment as a "second nature," the show brought together creators across art, design, and fashion.

2015

Jun 2015
EDITORIAL

MASSAGE 10 (print issue)

Editor · MASSAGE

B5 variant, 120 pages.

2014

Jan 2014
EDITORIAL

MASSAGE 9 — Internet Culture

Editor (with Kentaro Takaoka) · MASSAGE

256 pages, with included CD. Release event INTERNET CULTURE SHOP @ TOKYO CULTUART by BEAMS.

2005

2005
EDITORIAL

100 Japanese Motion Graphic Creators — Launch
Editor-in-Chief · BNN
Editor-in-chief continuing since.

2004

2004
EDITORIAL

MASSAGE — Launch
Founder / Editor-in-Chief
Founded as a print independent magazine focused on "events" in culture.

1990s

1990s
EDITORIAL

Independent magazines
Editor
Editing independent magazines with collaborators.

Selected Writings

2025

The Artists at the Intersection (Patterns of Entanglement feature)
Right Click Save · Co-author (with Alex Estorick)

2025

Tokyo Sets Stage for Exhibition of Media Ecologies
Right Click Save · Co-author

2025

Computational Poetry (review)
MASSAGE MAGAZINE (EN) · Editor / Author

2024

Questions for Art & Technology #1: Living as Human
CCBT · Author (notes)

2023

The Democratization and Fluidity of Expression
JAGDA — The Graphic Design Review · Author

2023

On Curation — Blockchain as a New Medium
Right Click Save · Author

2022

Right Click Live and Japan's New NFT Scene
Right Click Save · Author

2022

CryptoArt Pre-History
THE NEW CREATOR ECONOMY (BNN) · Author